

Logitech's Anand Lakshmanan on Logitech's product development, India's potential in the tech world, and more!

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Through the years, India has risen through the ranks in the world of technology. Be it in terms of product development, consumption, or awareness, we stand at one of the highest pedestals in the world. Now, with global brands like Logitech coming in with product lineups that are bigger than ever and spread across multiple verticals (for example - consumer electronics and enterprise solutions), there are a lot of questions that arise in the minds of people like us who are at the receiving end of these brands' innovations. So, when I got a chance to speak to Mr Anand Lakshmanan, Head of Logitech's business in India, during Infocomm India 2023, I asked him a ton of questions. They ranged from talking about the convergence of different verticals within the brand to their future plans in the country.

Here's a quick look at how our conversation panned out -

Q When Logitech as a brand, which is a global entity is developing products for different regions, different use cases, especially in the B2B sector, there are differences in the demands of people. So, in that process of development, where does India as a market stand for you?

A Almost all of Logitech solutions today are 50% hardware and 50% software. An example, cameras like this (Huddle Series), when we launched it, it had let's say 10



Anand Lakshmanan
Head of India, Logitech

features. Through software enhancements, we have improved the functionality of the hardware and this is not going to stop. This is how the future is going to be. And all this software that powers Logitech products are actually developed in India.

We have a big centre in Chennai, close to a thousand engineers every day wake up in the morning to make the experience of people who use Logitech products better.

Coming back to your core question, we actually do not make different products for different regions. India as a country gets exactly the same solutions that we launch annually. We do not have separate products anywhere in the world. The launches take place globally almost at the

same time. Just that in India, we have all the regulations that take a little bit more time because of which the launch dates are slightly different in India. Otherwise, we do not have separate products. Whatever Americans get to use, Indians get to use the same products in India as well.

From a B2B business, if you see a meeting room, challenges more or less are the same around the world, right? We have seen the rise of hybrid work environments, which has people logging in from different locations to be part of a meeting. The challenges that throws up for organisations and for users predominantly are the same. So our objective of providing solutions is also the same in terms of addressing those challenges.

Q Both on the consumer level and the business level, especially on the business level, how has India developed as a market for brands like Logitech where they were primarily making consumer-centric products, but now they are shifting into B2B business? What are the core things that have caused that monumental shift from consumer-centric approach to a more B2B and consumer-centric at the same time?

A One of the first trends that I can relate to is the adoption of video because of better internet availability.

Just imagine. Three, four years back, we were still on what we called broadband. Maybe the DTH guy was the one who was supplying internet, and it used to be through those coaxial cables. What speeds did we get? Maybe about 100 Mbps at that point in time. If you had 100 Mbps, you are probably somebody (special) in the society, right? Because that was the kind of incredible speeds that you could get. Now look at what we have at home. Fiber. 300 Mbps is your lowest or entry-level plan. You have 1 Gbps kind of speeds available for home users. I am not talking about offices. I have worked in offices where for an office of 20 people, we had like 100 Mbps. Today at an individual level, we can have 300 and 1 Gbps. So, the adoption of video is one of the primary reasons that I believe that India is what it